

Cover Letter

Dear Hiring Team,

I lead product at NodeOps, a startup selected this year for a major accelerator program. Going through that evaluation clarified something: what gets judged isn't features shipped; it's the clarity of the problem and the honesty of the evidence behind it. That's the standard I've built my decision-making around, and it's what this letter is about.

My resume covers what I've built; this letter is about how I decide because decision-making is the most important job any PM does, and I've built mine on a deliberate set of frameworks:

- **First principles before precedent.** "What do we know to be true?" comes before "what does everyone else do?" It's how I argued for a company-level pivot against momentum and sunk cost, rebuilding the case from raw evidence and not analogy.
- **Time and energy.** Prioritization is a discipline of *time*; what deserves the team's next hour is the highest-leverage call a PM makes. Pareto is a discipline of *energy*; finding the 20% of effort that drives 80% of the outcome, instead of mistaking motion for progress.
- **One-way vs. two-way doors.** If a decision is reversible, I make it fast; if rollback would be a disaster, I slow down and bring the team in. Speed and caution are both tools; the skill is knowing which door you're walking through.
- **Imagine the universe, solve a small part.** I start from the largest version of the vision, then ship the smallest wedge of it so if v1 succeeds, the next steps are already mapped, not improvised.
- **Objective before implementation.** No work starts until the goal is explicit; a clear objective makes every downstream choice more directed.
- **You can't manage what you can't measure.** Every decision ships with the instrumentation to tell me whether it was right.

Running a small team against well-funded competitors, these weren't philosophy, they were survival. And they're the muscle that scales: at LinkedIn, choosing the right problem compounds across millions of users.

Beyond that, I'm technical enough to earn engineers' trust, skeptical of my own ideas before anyone else has to be, and energized by ambiguity - the stage where the job is to create clarity, not consume it.

Sincerely, Siddharth Chadha